

# Nicholas Smith

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[github.com/firepenguindisopanda](https://github.com/firepenguindisopanda) | Open to remote work (UTC-4)

## Education & Certificates

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M.Sc. Data Science (part-time) from The University of the West Indies Expected 2028

B.Sc. Computer Science from The University of the West Indies, St. Augustine 2024

Certificates: IBM DevOps and Software Engineering; DeepLearning.AI Deep Learning Specialization

## Work History

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*Full-Time Teaching Assistant at UWI Dept. of Computing & IT, Trinidad* *September 2026 to Current*

- Supported five computing courses for 2026 to 2027, including Introduction to Data Analytics and Cloud Computing, by running practical lab sessions that helped students apply the concepts to graded coursework

*Contract Software Engineer at a Caribbean software consultancy* *August 2025 to Current*

- Built and maintained the Angular and Ionic frontend of a payroll and HR SaaS used in several Caribbean countries, with Playwright tests and CI that deployed it to seven tenant sites on Cloudflare Pages
- Rebuilt and upgraded other client apps over legacy Flask APIs that could not change, tested write paths against Docker replicas of production, and wrote a 54-finding production-readiness audit

*Part-Time Tutor at UWI Dept. of Computing & IT, Trinidad* *September 2024 to May 2026*

- Taught practical software engineering sessions to university students, covering version control, design patterns, CI/CD pipelines and testing workflows with Git and GitHub
- Mentored student project teams on Git and GitHub pull-request workflows through hands-on sessions, which brought 100% of the cohort onto version control for their group projects
- Delivered 12 practical sessions on Microsoft Access and Power BI so students could build dashboards

*Full Stack Developer at Scarlet Creative Software, Remote* *September 2024 to May 2025*

- Built and maintained full-stack web applications and AI tools for a marketing technology company using TypeScript, Nuxt.js, Firebase and Python on Google Cloud
- Designed and built a retrieval-augmented generation (RAG) assistant for a major advertising client with Python, LangChain and Pinecone, which the client said replaced digging through spreadsheets
- Rebuilt a drag-and-drop form builder with TypeScript, Nuxt.js and Firebase (Firestore, Storage, Cloud Functions), which cut average form creation time by 40% for marketing teams

- Wrote Firebase Cloud Functions for authentication and PDF report generation, and set up GitHub Actions pipelines that deployed the application to Google Cloud Run automatically

*Contract Developer and Intern at UWI Dept. of Computing & IT, Trinidad*

*January 2022 to June 2024*

- Delivered four fixed-term contracts and a summer internship on the department's web applications, built with Angular, React, Express.js and PostgreSQL
- Optimized an Express.js and PostgreSQL REST API by restructuring its endpoints and data models, which cut response payloads from 900 KB to 200 KB and page load times by 65%
- Profiled a slow PDF-parsing service with cProfile and reworked its text extraction and file I/O, which made document processing 99.59% faster
- Built GitHub Actions pipelines that ran unit and end-to-end tests on every pull request before Firebase Hosting deployment, and migrated an existing CircleCI workflow to GitHub Actions

## Projects

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*IdeaSprinter, Multi-Agent Spec Generator | Python, FastAPI, LangGraph, Next.js*

*2026*

- Built a multi-agent system in which 11 specialist LangGraph agents turn a product idea into a software specification, with a Next.js and React frontend that streams each agent's progress
- Added a skeptic agent and a NetworkX validator that surfaced contradictions between agents, with human approval checkpoints, circuit breakers and monthly token-cost limits

*Automated BI Reporting System | Python, FastAPI, LangChain, React, Docker*

*2026*

- Built a platform that scrapes a company website and runs a nine-stage LLM analysis pipeline to produce and email PDF and DOCX business reports, with live progress over server-sent events
- Scored every pipeline stage with a deterministic completeness check and an LLM critic, and gated prompt changes with a seven-fixture evaluation harness that includes a hallucination canary

## Technical Skills

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Languages: Python, TypeScript, JavaScript, SQL, HTML, CSS

Frameworks: FastAPI, React, Next.js, Nuxt.js (Vue), Angular, Node.js, Express.js, Flask, NestJS

AI and LLM: LangGraph, LangChain, RAG, Pinecone, FAISS, LLM evaluation, NVIDIA NIM

Data and Cloud: PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redis, Firebase, Google Cloud, Docker, Vercel

Practices: Git, GitHub Actions, CI/CD, REST APIs, pytest, Vitest, Playwright, Cypress, Agile

## Awards & Leadership

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WiDS Datathon, Trinidad and Tobago: 2nd place (2023, team lead) and 3rd place (2024), mentor since 2022; Tech Lead, UWI Computer Connections Unit apprenticeship (2024)